2026 *Preliminary* Recreational Summer Crab Harvest Update

9/25/2026 (Updated 9/28/2026)

DATA COLLECTION AND ENTRY IS UNDERWAY – ALL VALUES SUBJECT TO CHANGE

2026 Summer Season Reporting Summary To-date

Summer CRCs issued = **159,098**
Number of eCRCs issued = **50,660**
Number of electronic CRCs with catch = **17,715**
Reporting percentage for electronic cards to date = **58.0%**
Number of paper CRCs issued = **108,438**
Number of paper CRCs reported online to date = **15,002**
Online reporting percentage for paper cards to date = **13.8%**
Number of paper CRCs reported online to date with catch = **7,262**
Overall electronic reporting percentage (eCRC and paper) = **27.9%**

Early preliminary Dungeness crab recreational catch components and process

- Early preliminary catch is based only on catch reported via eCRC by electronic license holders (Method 1) or online paper reports and eCRC combined (Method 2).
- The late card set aside is ***not*** included as a separate component in the preliminary estimate. Late catch is accounted for in the expansion to total licenses.
- EUC placeholder values for each area are those used for 2025 recreational harvest estimate (TWG option 'C' method using only summer creel data through Labor Day each year; Table 4).
- Summer Charter Catch set aside is included as proposed in Table 2 of WDFW "Proposed Approach for the 2026 Recreational Harvest Estimation Methods" shared on 6/30/2026.
- Estimated average weight per crab by Marine Area is applied based on preliminary 2026 summer season dockside creel data (Table 4).
- EUC and weights by regional subareas are tracked separately and summed into Crab Management Regions based on Marine Area to Region/subregions proportions from the 2025 partitioning survey (Tables 5 and 6).
- A winter harvest set aside is based on a ratio of 2025 summer to winter harvest. This is only applied to areas where recreational fisheries may open based on preliminary catch totals (Table 7).

- Comanager decisions on application of EUC and crab weight will influence absolute values of the preliminary estimate and how they change over the course of the 2026 reporting period.

Part 1: Estimating total PUGET SOUND WIDE preliminary CRC reported harvest

METHOD 1: eCRC only

Method 1 expands reported catch based on license type proportion (paper vs eCRC). This method is identical to 'Method 1a' being proposed by the WDFW salmon managers.

During period *t (summer harvest season)*, the total harvest $\widehat{H}_t$ is estimated by dividing the mobile reported harvest M_t, by the proportion of reporting licenses to the total active licenses statewide ($\hat{p}_t$).

$$\widehat{H}_t = \frac{M_t}{\hat{p}_t}\,, \qquad \text{Eq. 1}$$

$$\hat{p}_t = \frac{e_t}{s_t}\,, \qquad \text{Eq. 2}$$

where,
$\widehat{H}_t$ is the estimated total harvest,
M_t is the total eCRC reported harvest,
$\hat{p}_t$ is the proportion of anglers reporting harvest via eCRC,
e_t is the number of valid statewide licenses selecting eCRC reporting option, and
s_t is the total number of valid statewide licenses (eCRC and paper card reporting).

Table 1: Parameters used to calculate $\widehat{H}_t$ based on eCRC catch reports. Units for $\widehat{H}_t$ are in number of crab.

Parameter	Value
M_t	164,630
e_t	50,660
s_t	159,098
$\hat{p}_t$	0.3184
$\widehat{H}_t$	**517,021**

METHOD 2: eCRC + Online reported paper CRCs

Method 2 stratifies by *license type, r,* and incorporates both eCRC and partial online reports. During period *t (summer harvest season)*, the total harvest $\widehat{H}_{t,r}$ by license type is applying the mean catch per successful card ($\bar{c}_{t,r}$) to the estimated successful crabbers for that license type. For the preliminary estimate, the estimated proportion of successful crabbers, $\hat{s}_{ecrc}$, is determined using eCRC data only as it represents nearly complete data for that reporting pathway. This assumption will be reviewed and updated as more paper reports are received. The total CRC-based preliminary harvest, $\widehat{H}_t$, is then calculated as the sum of estimated catch for each license type, $\widehat{H}_{t,r}$.

$$\widehat{H}_{t,r} = \hat{s}_{ecrc} * T_{t,r} * \bar{c}_{t,r} \quad \text{Eq. 3}$$

$$\hat{s}_{ecrc} = \frac{n_{ecrc}}{T_{ecrc}} \quad \text{Eq. 4}$$

$$\widehat{H}_t = \sum_{r \in R} \widehat{H}_{t,r} \quad \text{Eq. 5}$$

Where,

$\widehat{H}_{t,r}$ is the total estimated CRC harvest for season t by license type r
$T_{t,r}$ is the total number of licenses for season t by type r
$\bar{c}_{t,r}$ is the mean catch per successful card for season t for license type r
n_t = number of eCRCs reporting catch (non-zero) during season t
$\hat{s}_{ecrc}$ is the proportion reporting catch (non-zero) on eCRCs by for season r
$\widehat{H}_t$ is the estimated total preliminary harvest for season t

For eCRC

$$\bar{c}_{t,r} = \frac{M_{t,r}}{n_{t,r}}$$

Where,

M_t is the total electronically reported harvest on for season t
n_t = number of eCRCs reporting catch (non-zero) during season t

For paper

$$\bar{c}_t = \frac{M_{t,r}}{n_{t,r}}$$

M_t is the total electronically reported harvest on for season t
n_t = number of paper CRCs electronically reporting catch (non-zero) during season t

Table 2: Parameters used to calculate Method 2 catch by license type strata based on eCRC catch reports and preliminary online paper reports.

Parameter	eCRC	Paper
$T_{t,r}$	50,660	108,438
M_t	164,630	100,517
$n_{t,r}$	17,715	7,262
$\bar{c}_{t,r}$	9.2933	13.8415
$\hat{s}_{ecrc}$	0.3497	
$\widehat{H}_{t,r}$	164,630	524,857
$\widehat{H}_t$	**686,487**	

For the purposes of in-season management, Method 2 is selected and applied for next steps

<u>Part 2:</u> Converting the total PS-wide harvest to catch by Marine Area

The eCRC and preliminary online paper catch reports (in crab number) are summarized by marine area and the proportion of total harvest was distributed by proportion of catch reported for each area.

Table 3: Summarized eCRC and online paper catch reports by marine Area expanded to estimated total CRC catch by marine area.

Marine Area	Reported eCRC Catch (N)	Reported paper Catch (N)	Reported Total Catch (N)	Percent of Total Harvest (N)	Estimated total CRC catch by Marine Area (N)
4	72	48	120	0.000	314
5	217	276	493	0.002	1290
6	6018	4608	10626	0.040	27811
7	49955	34168	84123	0.319	220173
81	32785	21034	53819	0.204	140859
82	32122	18544	50666	0.192	132607
9	12540	6999	19539	0.074	51139
10	16176	6073	22249	0.084	58232
11	7530	2630	10160	0.039	26592
12	6581	4427	11008	0.042	28811
13	629	5	634	0.002	1659
Total	164625	98812	263437	1	**689487**

<u>Part 3:</u> Adding in EUC, area-specific weights and charter catch

For the preliminary estimates, the following components are added to the CRC estimate.

- 2025 EUC values for each Region/subregion as they were applied in the 2025 harvest estimates. These are based on the TWG recommendation 'C' using summer data through Labor Day.
- Charter harvest set aside following what was described the "Proposed Approach for the 2026 Recreational Harvest Estimation Methods" shared on 6/30/2026. This amounts to 9,192 pounds distributed across marine areas based on the last 6 years of charter stamps reports.
- Mean crab weight by marine area based on preliminary creel data from the 2026 dockside survey. Values are reflected in Table 4 below.

Table 4: Table showing calculations of the preliminary total estimated harvest for the Puget Sound Dungeness crab fishery by Marine Area based on eCRC reports and a portion of paper reports submitted electronically through 9/24/2026.

Marine Area	Estimated Total # of crab	Catch Proportion	EUC Percent	EUC Catch	Total Catch + EUC	Charter	Total Catch (non-EUC)	Total Catch w/EUC	Weights	Total Catch (non-EUC) lbs	Total Catch EUC. Lbs
4	314	0.000	0.19740	62	376	0	314	376	1.92	603	119
5	1290	0.002	0.19740	255	1545	33	1323	1578	1.92	2541	489
6	27811	0.040	0.19740	5490	33301	82	27893	33383	1.96	54671	10760
7	220173	0.319	0.19740	43462	263635	5568	225741	269203	1.90	428908	82578
81	140859	0.204	0.17890	25200	166059		140859	166059	2.00	281718	50399
82	132607	0.192	0.21080	27954	160560	344	132951	160904	1.88	249948	52553
9 (total)	51139										
9 (non-25C)	40553	0.059	0.15210	6168	46721	949	41502	47671	1.88	78024	11596
9 (25C)	10586	0.015	0.19740	2090	12675	248	10834	12923	1.92	20800	4012
10	58232	0.084	0.19740	11495	69727	1960	60192	71687	1.88	113160	21610
11	26592	0.039	0.20660	5494	32085	8	26600	32093	1.90	50539	10438
12	28811	0.042	0.19740	5687	34498		28811	34498	1.92	55317	10920
13	1659	0.002	0.19740	328	1987		1659	1987	1.92	3186	629
Total	**689,487**	1.000		**133,683**	**823,170**	**9,192**	**698,679**	**832,362**		**1,339,416**	**256,104**

<u>Part 4:</u> Converting the catch by Marine Areas into catch by Crab Management Region.

Partitioning parameters for Regions 1, 3, 2W, and 5 for the preliminary estimates were those from the 2025 crabber survey. Marine Area totals are divided or summed based on the apportionment fraction to determine the recreational catch by Crab Management Region.

Table 5: Marine Area-to-Regional Sub-area partitioning.

Catch Apportioning and EUC Parameters	Apportioning Fraction
MA 4/R3-4	1
MA 5/R3-4	1
MA 6/R1	0.044
MA 6/R3-1	0.079
MA 6/R3-2	0.865
MA 6/R3-3	0.012
MA7/R1	0.969
MA7/R3-1	0.031
MA8-1/R2E	1
MA8-2/R2E	1
MA 9/R2W	0.793
MA 9/R5	0.207
MA10/R4	1
MA11/R6	1
MA12/R5	1
MA13/R7	1

Table 6. PRELIMINARY Summer 2026 recreational catch components (in pounds of crab harvested) combined into regions and sub-regions based on the parameters shown in Table 5.

Crab Management Region	Marine Area	Total Catch (lbs.) No EUC	EUC (lbs.)	Total Catch + EUC (lbs.)
1	7	418,017	80,492	498,509
2E	8-1, 8-2	531,666	102,952	634,618
2W	9 (non-25C)	78,024	11,596	89,621
3-1	6	17,615	3,410	21,025
3-2	6	47,290	9,308	56,598
3-3	6	656	129	785
3-4	4, 5	3,144	608	3,752
4	10	113,160	21,610	134,771
5	12 (including 25C)	76,117	14,932	91,049
6	11	50,539	10,438	60,977
7	13	3,186	629	3,815
-	**Total**	1,339,416	256,104	1,595,519

2026/2027 Season State Crab Landings Update - 9/24/2026

- Includes preliminary eCRC reports and partial online reports through 9/24/2026. Placeholder values are used for EUC and Charter Catch. Preliminary area specific crab weights are applied.

2026-2027 PUGET SOUND DUNGENESS CRAB HARVEST SUMMARY

Preliminary Summer Estimate with 27.9% Summer CRC's and Projected Winter Estimate with 0% Winter CRC's Reporting

Rec Estimate Date:	9/25/2026
Comm Data Date:	NA
Summer Summary Type:	Preliminary
Summer Reporting Rate:	27.9
Winter Summary Type:	Projected
Winter Reporting Rate:	0.0

Management Region	Marine Area(s)	Regional State Share	Regional State Adjusted Share	State Summer Recreational Catch	State Summer EUC	State Winter Recreational Catch	State Winter EUC	State Commercial Harvest	State Commercial EUC	Total State Harvest To-Date	State Balance To-Date
1	7	2,300,000	2,300,000	418,017	80,492	58,010	11,170	0	0	567,688	1,732,312
2E	8-1,8-2	1,300,000	1,300,000	531,666	102,952	43,627	8,448	0	0	686,693	613,307
2W	9 less 25C	225,000	225,000	78,024	11,596	19,049	2,831	0	0	111,501	113,499
3-1	6, N	45,000	45,000	17,615	3,410	2,541	492	0	0	24,058	20,942
3-2	6, SE	375,000	375,000	47,290	9,308	7,295	1,436	0	0	65,328	309,672
3-3	6, W	15,500	15,500	656	129	101	20	0	0	906	14,594
3-4	4, 5	9,500	9,500	3,144	608	594	115	0	0	4,461	5,039
4	10	57,000	57,000	113,160	21,610	-	0	0	0	134,771	-77,771
5	12 incl 25C	202,194	202,194	76,117	14,932	20,238	3,970	0	0	115,257	86,937
6	11	63,917	56,370	50,539	10,438	-		0	0	60,977	-4,607
7	13	0	0	3,186	629	-	-	0	0	3,815	-3,815
STATE HARVEST TOTALS		**4,593,111**	**4,585,564**	**1,339,416**	**256,104**	**151,455**	**28,482**	**0**	**0**	**1,775,456**	

Regional Shares: RED indicates areas without a signed plan

DATA BASED ON:

Regional Shares: RED indicates areas without a signed plan

Recreational harvest from Marine Areas 6, 7, and 9 are partitioned based on online crabber surveys conducted in 2025.

Preliminary harvest is based on eCRC and partial online reports.

Creel-based weights are being applied from the 2026 creel data

EUC placeholder is what was used for the 2025 recreational estimates (see 2025 memo)

Winter projected harvest is based on the ratio of summer to winter harvest from the 2025 season.

Table 7: Ratios calculated from the 2025 Summer and Winter recreational fishery to estimate 2026 projected winter harvest.

Management Region	Marine Area(s)	State Summer Recreational Catch	State Winter Recreational Catch	Winter to Summer Harvest Ratio
1	7	524,122	72,734	**0.139**
2E	8-1,8-2	830,763	68,170	**0.082**
2W	9 less 25C	121,612	29,691	**0.244**
3-1	6, N	25,938	3,742	**0.144**
3-2	6, SE	102,233	15,770	**0.154**
3-3	6, W	1,418	218	**0.154**
3-4	4, 5	4,342	821	**0.189**
4	10	85,266	41,494	
5	12 incl 25C	67,667	17,991	**0.266**
6	11	70,908	556	
7	13	286	47	
STATE HARVEST TOTALS		**1,834,555**	**251,223**	